# 2013 Honda Civic HF

$8,000 · 140,000 miles · Private seller · Palmdale, CA

Seller: Private seller

Source: Craigslist

Listing: https://www.craigslist.org/view/d/palmdale-2013-honda-civic-hf-not-hybrid/wTvivNFGaXfD9iZcTfs4uh

Report generated October 29, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder










+ 4 more photos in the app.

| Out-the-door price | Monthly cost to own | Reliability |
|---|---|---|
| **$8,980** | **$471** | **Good** |
| Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare. | loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration | 4/5 · 0 recalls · 319 NHTSA complaints |

## Budget — buying it

| | |
|---|---|
| Vehicle price | $8,000.00 |
| Use tax (9.25%) — paid at DMV | $740.00 |
| Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price) | $52.00 |
| Registration + CHP fee | $108.00 |
| Transportation improvement fee | $65.00 |
| Title transfer | $15.00 |
| Total out-the-door | $8,980.00 |
| + Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop) | $150.00 |

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

## Budget — paying for it

| | |
|---|---|
| Down payment | $5,000.00 |
| Amount financed | $3,980.00 |
| Monthly loan payment (60 mo @ 7.5% APR) | $79.75 |
| Total interest over the loan | $805.06 |
| Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection) | $5,150.00 |

## Budget — owning it each month

| | |
|---|---|
| Loan payment | $79.75 |
| Insurance (estimate, full) | $135.00 |
| Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 33 MPG, $4.75/gal) | $143.94 |
| Maintenance & repair reserve | $95.00 |
| Registration renewal (÷12) | $16.83 |
| Total per month | $470.52 |

Running costs without the loan: **$391/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$14,095** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

## Insurance

| Coverage | Typical Ridgecrest range | Estimate used |
|---|---|---|
| Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15) | $49–$112/mo | $70/mo |
| Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive) | $94–$243/mo | $135/mo |

The budget above uses the **full coverage** estimate ($135/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: common sedan/hatch. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

## Reliability

**Rating: Good (4/5)**

The 2013 Civic (1.8L R18, 5-speed auto) is one of the more reliable used compacts; 2013 fixed most of the 2012 redesign complaints. At 140k it needs its maintenance history checked.

NHTSA data for this model year: 0 recalls · 319 owner complaints (29 involving a crash). Most complaints: Air Bags (114), Service Brakes (39), Electrical System (39), Steering (38), Unknown Or Other (29), Structure (23).

**Known issues for this model**

• A/C compressor / condenser failures

• Engine mount wear (vibration at idle)

• Valve adjustment due ~100-110k if never done

• Takata airbag recall - confirm completed

**Check on this car before buying**

• Title in seller's name and matches VIN

• Run VIN for recalls (Takata)

• A/C cold at idle in heat

• Vibration at idle in Drive (mounts)

• Ask for valve adjustment / transmission fluid service records

## Notes

$8,000 cash only, ~140k mi, automatic, clean title (per ad), backup camera, new tires. Found 2026-10-23.

HF = the high-fuel-economy Civic (aero wheels/underbody): EPA 29 city / 41 hwy / 33 combined - best highway MPG on the list.

Ad is keyword-stuffed and cash-only, so it may be a flipper: make sure the title is in the seller's name, get the VIN and run it, and pre-purchase inspect. Top of budget - try to negotiate.

## Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.